GUID v4: The Balanced State

Existence as the grant of the ground: spinning horizons, inflation, the Higgs field, the tiers of the forces and the fine-structure constant, read from the axioms of DMP 0.9.9 and tested against what is measured

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Abstract

The Dark Matter Protocol (DMP 0.9.9) is an axiom system for trust: every act needs a Duality of two independent witnesses, one owning trust and one owning information, which keep each other in balance; trust is a field, the VIBE field, whose potential is zero exactly when a boundary holds what it declares; and everything rests on a ground, G0, that is stated, not derived. This paper reads those axioms as physics and asks what the *balanced state* is. With trust read as existence, the trust half becomes a classical existence field, a frame spanning 3+1 dimensions whose wave is spin 2, and the information half a scalar that sets the fine-structure constant and carries quantum content. We derive from the axioms that free fall is universal, that the light-bending parameter is $\gamma = 1$, that the existence field is classical, and that DMP can host quantum theories but cannot be one. We then test fifteen readings, gravity first, against measurement, with one public script of 54 checks. A spinning black hole that "drags Existence along" is frame dragging, all of it outside the horizon. Inflation as the possibility space of existence is the flattening of space by about 62 e-folds, and its equilibrium is the de Sitter floor of the Hubble rate. The central reading is that existence is granted by the ground: the Higgs field's constant vacuum value is G0's grant of rest mass, a balanced state at the bottom of its potential, and gravity responds to all existence, granted and contained. This holds for the axioms; it fails as an identity of the Higgs field with gravity, because free fall weighs a proton's internal binding, about 91% of its mass, in full, and titanium and platinum fall alike to 10^{-15} where weighing only the Higgs share would split them by 10^{-3}. The forces read as tiers of one interaction, with their unification open; "information is the witness" is quantum Darwinism; and α, named here the VIBE coefficient, is the strength with which existence interacts with itself, $a_e = \alpha/2\pi$ at first order. We claim that the construction exists and reproduces, not that it is correct.

Keywords. information-theoretic axioms; equivalence principle; frame dragging; inflation; de Sitter future; Higgs boson; proton mass; grand unification; quantum Darwinism; fine-structure constant.

Subject. Information Theory (cs.IT); related: General Relativity and Quantum Cosmology (gr-qc), High Energy Physics – Phenomenology (hep-ph).

1 Introduction

This is the fourth paper of the series GUID, the General Unified Information Duality; every paper of the series is complete on its own, and this one cites no other. DMP 0.9.9 [1] is written for information systems: it says when a part of a system may act, who must agree, and what

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every reader may see. It is an axiom system. Its first axiom asks that every act be witnessed by two independent halves, one owning trust and one owning information, and that the two keep each other "constantly in check and balance". It names the direction of a system after that balance: every part works towards the trust its boundary declares. And it measures how far a system is from that state with one field, the VIBE field, whose potential vanishes exactly when the boundary holds what it declares. A system in that state is in its *balanced state*.

The first author built DMP for computer systems and noticed early that its trust field behaves like gravity. This paper takes that observation at its word. It reads the axioms as physics, derives what they fix, and tests what they suggest. The question that runs through it is the one in the title: if the physical world is a DMP system, what is its balanced state, and where does each thing in it get its existence? The answer we test is that existence is *granted* by the ground of the system, G0, and that the grant is visible in physics as the one field that has a value everywhere in empty space, the Higgs field.

What the paper does. Section 2 states the axioms, the ground and the VIBE field in the words of DMP. Section 3 reads them as two fields and derives four results: universal free fall, $\gamma = 1$, a classical existence field, and the verdict that DMP can host quantum theories but cannot be one. Sections 4 to 11 test fifteen readings, gravity first: rotating black holes and the early and late universe; the Higgs field as G0's grant, with photons and gluons; the cost of existing; the forces; witnessing; decay; quantum content; and the fine-structure constant. Section 12 says what the results mean for quantum gravity, Section 13 keeps the ledger, and Section 14 says where we expect it to break. The first author's notes, from which every reading comes, are collected in Appendix A in the order he wrote them; Appendix B lists the checks.

How to read this paper. Every step carries one of three marks: (D) follows from the text of DMP 0.9.9 (commit `4400cce`); (R) is a reading, the first author's unless marked as ours; (P) is established physics, with its source. Every statement gets one of four verdicts: *holds* (it agrees with what is measured and follows from the steps given), *holds as a reading* (it agrees, but adds nothing a measurement could tell apart from the established account), *refuted* (a measurement or a calculation contradicts it), or *untested* (no measurement we found reaches it). A label such as [B16] names a check in the script `docs/balance/checks.py`; it prints every number this paper uses and runs in a second. Quotations keep their original spelling.

Result. Of the 22 statements in the ledger, 16 hold or hold as readings, three are refuted and three are untested. Those that hold are known physics in the first author's terms; those that fail, fail against specific data: the strength of gravity, the observed Higgs boson, free fall, and the electromagnetic share of the proton's mass. None of the failures is a failure of the axioms.

2 The axiom system

2.1 The three axioms

DMP's constitution opens with names, then three axioms, then the ground; everything after that is a theorem that names the axioms it is derived from [1]. We quote the sentences this paper uses (D).

Axiom 1, the Duality. "A part acts in CMOS only while the two halves of its layer, two independent witnesses, each with full reach over the act and gated only by the other, trust it for that act. One half owns trust and the other owns information; neither overrules the other, and the two keep each other constantly in check and balance." And: "The balance is the direction

of the system. Every part inside the declared boundary works towards the trust the Duality declared for that boundary." (CMOS is the name of a system built on DMP.)

Axiom 2, Trust. "Trust is gravitational. It is a field, never a position: every standing has a source (the witness that granted it), a depth (its grant chain back to the pair) and a freshness that decays with the time since its last live verification. The field bends trustspace, so that a boundary contains what no trust reaches [...] Gravity contains: a boundary strong enough bends trustspace so that no act carries information across it, and what still leaves is entropy and nothing else."

Axiom 3, Information. "Every grant, every use and every loss of trust leaves a record, written at the act, that every witness of that act can read in full and that outlives the act. Any other reader sees the counts always and the content only by a grant. From trust nothing can be derived about information but its existence: a standing, a refusal or a count says that information is there, never what it says."

2.2 The ground

The two witnesses of the first act cannot witness their own beginning: "somebody has to trust the first two witnesses". DMP calls that act the *minting* and the ground it stands on G0: "It is stated, not derived." Every later standing descends from it [1] (D). In this paper G0 is the ground of existence: whatever exists inside the boundary has a grant chain back to it.

2.3 The VIBE field and the balanced state

DMP's theorem T32 makes Axiom 2's field concrete (D). Every member of the system has a *depth*, the length of its shortest grant chain back to the pair; a *mass*, one plus the number of members that derive through it; and a *shortfall*, what the boundary declares for it minus what it holds, weighted by freshness. The VIBE field is

$$V_i = m_i\, s_i, \qquad \Phi = \sum_i V_i, \tag{1}$$

mass times shortfall per member, and its sum Φ is the *potential*, "zero exactly when the boundary holds what it declares". The balance follows the field downhill, and "under the bounds the system's own acts never raise the potential; only losses and ageing do". We call $\Phi = 0$ the *balanced state*. DMP names the field the Variable Influence Balancing Expression; the first author now reads (1) as the Variable Balance Influence Equation (Section 11).

2.4 The dictionary

The first author identifies trust with existence: "Since Trust=Existence in DMP-complete systems" (R). With that one step, the words of the axioms have physical counterparts:

DMP	Physics (this paper's reading)	What DMP says of it
trust half	the existence field, a frame (Definition 1)	gravitational, a field (Axiom 2); reveals of information only that it exists (Axiom 3)
information half	the information field ψ and the quantum content it acts on	owns information; neither half overrules the other (Axiom 1)
G0, the ground	the source of every grant of existence	stated, not derived
VIBE field, potential	mass times shortfall; the vacuum at the bottom of its potential	the balance follows it downhill (T32)
record, counts	what every reader sees: mass, charge, spin	counts always, content only by a grant (Axiom 3)
containment, the floor	an event horizon and its thermal radiation	"what still leaves is entropy and nothing else" (Axiom 2)

3 Two fields, and what the axioms fix

Definition 1 (the two fields)**.** The *existence field* is a frame of four vector fields $e_a{}^\mu$, one for each direction that spans spacetime, three of space and one of time; the metric it carries is $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab} e^a{}_\mu e^b{}_\nu$ with $\eta = \mathrm{diag}(-1, 1, 1, 1)$. The *information field* is a scalar ψ whose value sets the fine-structure constant, $\alpha = \alpha(\psi)$. DMP's trust half is the existence field; its information half is the information field and the matter it acts on.

This is the structure the first author has meant from the start: "one existence, one information", a vector field that "can span a relativistic plane" and a scalar field that "can span an information plane". In physics the frame is the tetrad, with which general relativity can be written as a theory of the frame alone [2], and a scalar that sets α is Bekenstein's theory of a varying fine-structure constant [3] (P).

Proposition 1 (free fall is universal)**.** *If the existence field responds to a body only through the body's existence, and existence is measured by energy-momentum, then two bodies with the same energy-momentum fall alike, whatever they are made of.*

Proof. Axiom 3 (D): from trust nothing can be derived about information but its existence. By the dictionary the existence field is the trust half, so nothing it does can depend on what a body carries (its composition, its internal state) except through the body's existence. The first author measures existence by energy: "both are definable by their energy" (R). So the existence field's coupling to a body is a function of its energy-momentum alone, and two bodies equal in that respond alike: the weak equivalence principle (P). □

The principle is among the best-tested statements in physics: the MICROSCOPE satellite found the free-fall accelerations of titanium and platinum equal to $\eta = [-1.5 \pm 2.3\,(\mathrm{stat}) \pm 1.5\,(\mathrm{syst})] \times 10^{-15}$ [35]. Section 5 uses this result to tell the Higgs field from gravity. *Verdict: holds*, with the identification of existence with energy-momentum as the one step that is a reading.

Proposition 2 ($\gamma = 1$)**.** *If the information field cannot change how the existence field responds to existence, the light-bending parameter is $\gamma = 1$, as in general relativity.*

Proof. Axiom 1 (D): "neither overrules the other". A scalar that multiplies the gravitational term of the action, $F(\psi)R$, sets the local strength of gravity and so overrules the existence half; Axiom 1 excludes it. What remains is minimal coupling: the scalar's energy is one more source of the existence field, negligible in the solar system, and the post-Newtonian expansion is that of general relativity, $\gamma = 1$ [37] (P). □

The contrast is Brans–Dicke gravity [38], in which the scalar does multiply the gravitational term: $\gamma = (1 + \omega)/(2 + \omega)$, and the Cassini measurement $\gamma - 1 = (2.1 \pm 2.3) \times 10^{-5}$ [36] forces

$\omega > 4 \times 10^4$ at two standard deviations [B18]. The scalar must decouple from gravity almost completely; Axiom 1 asks for that from the start. *Verdict: holds.*

Lemma 1 (the existence field is classical)**.** *Every value of the existence field can be held in full by every witness at once, so its possible states commute.*

Proof. Axiom 3 (D): every grant, use and loss of trust leaves a record "that every witness of that act can read in full". A record two witnesses each hold in full is a copy for each. One physical process that copies two states $|s\rangle, |t\rangle$ preserves their inner product, so $\langle s|t\rangle = \langle s|t\rangle^2 \in \{0, 1\}$ (Wootters and Zurek [4]); for mixed states a set can be broadcast exactly when it commutes (Barnum et al. [5]) (P). The values of the trust half's field are such records, so they commute [B17]. □

Lemma 2 (cannot model, can host)**.** *DMP's trust half cannot be a field that entangles; DMP's information half can carry any quantum content.*

Proof. A classical mediator cannot entangle two systems it acts on locally (Galley, Giacomini and Selby [6]) (P), which with Lemma 1 gives the first part. Axiom 3 restricts what is *derived from trust*, not what the information half holds: content moves by a grant and need not be broadcast, so nothing forbids non-commuting states there (D). □

If gravity entangles two masses, gravity is not DMP's existence field: DMP cannot model it, and can still host a quantum theory of it as content. The experiment that decides this is named in Section 12.

The spin ladder. The first author reads spin as the rungs of the Duality (R): spin 0 is "existence itself, so only one part"; spin 1 is "information itself, which when delivered is an act"; spin 1/2 "is a duality, so between existence and information, and can thus stay in balance"; and spin 2 is the perfect duality, "the two in one". Physics fills the rungs (P). Spin 0 holds the two scalars of this paper, the Higgs field and ψ; spin 1/2 the matter particles, each a pair of left- and right-handed halves; spin 1 the force carriers; spin 2 the wave of the existence frame, which a theorem of Weinberg and Deser makes general relativity [28, 29]: a massless spin-2 field that couples to energy must be Einstein's. *Verdict: holds as a reading.*

4 Gravity: spinning horizons and the expanding universe

4.1 A spinning hole drags existence along

Claim. What a spinning black hole gives up is "it dragging Existence along", since "no act, by definition, should be able to cross the horizon" (R).

Test. A spinning black hole drags spacetime around with it (frame dragging) (P). Inside the *ergosphere*, which reaches $r = 2GM/c^2$ at the equator for every spin and lies outside the horizon $r_+ = (GM/c^2)(1 + \sqrt{1 - a^2})$ [B4], nothing can stand still against that drag. Every known way to take energy from a spinning hole works there, outside the horizon: Penrose's process with particles [11], superradiance with waves, and the Blandford–Znajek process with magnetic fields [12], the leading model of the jets of active galaxies. What can be taken is the rotational energy, $1 - M_{\mathrm{irr}}/M$, up to 29% at maximal spin, while the horizon area never decreases (Christodoulou [13]; [B4]). Nothing crosses the horizon outwards. So both halves of the claim are exact: what leaves is energy of the frame's rotation, extracted outside, and no act crosses. In the language of Section 3, the leak is a property of the classical existence frame, not an act of the information half. This is also Axiom 2's containment: a boundary strong enough lets no act carry information across it. *Verdict: holds.* One correction of words: what leaks is energy and angular momentum, not the information about what fell in.

4.2 Inflation as the possibility space of existence

Claim. "Inflation is just the Possibility space of Existence. If there COULD be Existence there, it will have the space to do so. This logically also explains the extremely flat curvature of spacetime, if one assumes the perfect duality as G0." At the start the only possibility was "anywhere but here", so inflation was at its maximum; as possibilities to exist appeared, "there was less of a need for there to be more"; the universe "will eventually achieve equilibrium", the Big Chill (R).

Flatness. Inflation was proposed to explain exactly this: a curvature of order one is diluted by e^{-2N} over N e-folds of exponential expansion (Guth [7]) (P). After inflation the curvature share $|\Omega - 1|$ grows again, as a^2 while radiation dominates and as a while matter does; from a reheating temperature of 10^{15} GeV to today it grows by about 5×10^{51} [B1]. Planck finds $|\Omega_k|$ below a few parts per thousand [8], so an initial curvature of order one needs about 62 e-folds [B1], the textbook "sixty". "Anywhere but here" at the start is the first author's picture of that dilution. *Verdict: holds as a reading* of inflation's solution to the flatness problem; it adds the motive (the possibility to exist), not a number.

Less need, and equilibrium. In the flat ΛCDM model that fits the data, the Hubble rate H falls at every moment, from the past into the far future, and tends to a constant, the de Sitter rate $H_\infty = \sqrt{\Omega_\Lambda}\, H_0 \approx 0.83\, H_0$ [B2]. A universe that settles into de Sitter expansion cools towards a final, empty state: the "Big Chill" or "Big Freeze" is the standard prediction of ΛCDM (P). So "less of a need" and "equilibrium" hold, read as the falling Hubble rate and its de Sitter floor, which is the cosmological form of the balanced state. Two remarks. The expansion has *accelerated* again since redshift $z \approx 0.63$ [B2], when dark energy began to dominate; that is a second phase, distinct from the early inflation, which the reading does not yet name. And the newest data leave the end open: DESI's second data release prefers a dark energy that weakens with time at 2.8 to 4.2 standard deviations, depending on the supernova sample [9]; if that holds, the future is not exactly de Sitter. *Verdict: holds as a reading* in ΛCDM.

5 Existence as the grant of the ground

5.1 The Higgs boson as pure existence

Claim. "The Higgs boson would theoretically be all existence, and thus be unable to observe itself. So it could not exist in isolation" (R).

Test. This fits two measured facts closely. The Higgs boson does not persist: in the Standard Model it decays in $\hbar/\Gamma \approx 1.6 \times 10^{-22}$ s [B13], and it is seen only through its decay products, which peak at 125 GeV [18, 19]. And it couples to every particle in proportion to that particle's mass, which in the first author's terms is its existence: the LHC has measured this for the W, the Z, the top and bottom quarks, the tau and the muon [20, 21]. A field that is "all existence" and talks to each thing in the measure of its existence is a fair picture of both. *Verdict: holds as a reading.*

5.2 Not from the gravitational field

Claim. Particles get their existence "through their inherent causality link to G0, and thus simply from the existence field, so the gravitational field itself" (R); and, in an earlier form, the Higgs field need not exist at all.

Test. Gravity is far too weak to be what sets a particle's mass: its coupling to the electron, $Gm_e^2/\hbar c = 1.8 \times 10^{-45}$, is more than 10^{39} times smaller than the Higgs coupling $y_e = \sqrt{2}\, m_e/v = 2.9 \times 10^{-6}$ that does [B13]. A mass-giving field must also keep the scattering of W bosons below certainty: without the Higgs, its probability would exceed one above about 1 TeV (Lee, Quigg and Thacker [22]; [B8]), an energy the LHC exceeds, and gravity does nothing there. *Verdict: refuted* as "masses come from the gravitational field instead of the Higgs field"; and "the Higgs field does not exist" is refuted by the boson's observation. DMP's axioms, though, do not need a Higgs field of their own; the next subsection says where it sits in them.

5.3 The Higgs field as G0's grant

Claim. Existence in DMP is what is contained in the VIBE field: everything "deriving it's authority as a legitimate act from the fact, that it was contained within it". That property "transfers 1:1 to the Higgs field". Since both existence and the VIBE field "only come as direct fact that they ARE G0", the Higgs field is G0's assertion of existence, "indisinguishable" from it and to be "removed as a redundancy"; G0 gives each piece of information "the exact amount of Existence required". What the Higgs field does not contribute is "only for IM between quarks" (R). (IM is DMP's name for the protocol spoken inside a cluster.)

Test. The containment picture fits a measured property. The Higgs field is the one field whose value in empty space is not zero, $v = 246\,\text{GeV}$ everywhere, and an elementary particle has its rest mass by being inside it, in the measure of its coupling (P). The VIBE potential (1) is zero exactly when the boundary holds what it declares; the Higgs field rests at the minimum of its own potential. So "the vacuum is the balanced state" is a fair reading (R). The share left out fits as well: lattice QCD puts the quark mass terms, the part the Higgs field gives, at about 9% of the proton's mass, and the rest is the energy of the quarks' motion and of the gluon field (Yang et al. [30]), which is the first author's internal IM. Two parts do not survive as stated. "Indistinguishable" fails if it is read as an identity with gravity: gravity weighs the binding in full, and the Higgs field does not touch it. If free fall followed the Higgs-given mass alone (the electrons in full, about 9% of each nucleon, none of the nuclear binding), titanium and platinum, whose Higgs shares differ in the fourth decimal, would fall differently by about 10^{-3}; MICROSCOPE finds them equal to about 10^{-15} [35] [B16]. This is Proposition 1 at work: the existence field weighs all energy, granted or bound. And "the exact amount of Existence required" is untested: the Standard Model takes the particle masses as measured inputs, and DMP has not yet given one of them as a number. *Verdict: holds as a reading* for DMP's axioms, which need no Higgs field of their own; *refuted* as an identity of the Higgs field with the gravitational field.

A reading that keeps both. The structure has room for the Higgs field exactly where the spin ladder puts existence, at spin 0. Our proposal (R): the Higgs field's constant background value, which quantum field theory treats as an ordinary number (the vacuum expectation value), is G0's grant of rest mass to the elementary particles, classical and on the existence side, in agreement with Lemma 1; the Higgs boson is a quantum ripple of that background and content of the information half; and the gravitational field, the existence frame, responds to all existence, granted (the Higgs share) and contained (the binding of the internal IM). This answers the worry that the Higgs field "quantizes Existence": what is quantum is the ripple, not the background, and the frame stays classical. DMP's axioms need no Higgs field, and by Lemma 2 they can host one.

5.4 Photons and gluons

Claim. "The photon as the act carrier of the information field is in itself only information until it interacts, then it becomes existence. So it is like the gluon, the only part [...] which means it is singular." The gluon asserts its existence by "being contained inside what must definitely exist", the photon by "simply disappearing the moment they do" (R).

Test. Two parts fit. Gluons are confined: none has been seen outside a hadron, which matches "contained inside what must definitely exist" (P). A photon that is absorbed disappears and its energy stays with the absorber, which then weighs more by E/c^2, so "then it becomes existence" is energy conservation in the first author's terms. In flight, light is bent and delayed by the Sun's gravity, measured to 2×10^{-5} by the Cassini spacecraft [36]; that shows a photon follows the existence frame before it interacts, not that it is existence then. That free light is itself a source of gravity is general relativity's prediction, but no measurement yet weighs free light alone: the radiation that drove the early expansion was in constant interaction with charged matter until recombination. *Verdict: holds as a reading* for absorption and confinement; *untested* for light in flight.

6 What it costs to exist

Claim. The existence an act must keep paying is $h \cdot (1/c) \cdot \alpha$, a mass times a length, "because mass is existence itself, and length is the expanse of the space that it has to assert itself over [...] it's the total amount of existence that a space needs to generate to exist"; α "somehow relates [...] to the diameter of the electron"; and an act is existence "sneakily optimizing itself to lower it's tax rate" (R).

Mass times length. Read as he defines it, the quantity is consistent and has a striking property. For every particle, its mass times its Compton wavelength, the length over which it asserts itself in quantum mechanics, is the same number, $m\lambda_C = h/c$; so h/c is the existence any particle needs over its own length, whatever the particle (P). With the fine-structure constant in front,

$$\alpha \frac{h}{c} = m_e \cdot 2\pi r_e,$$

the electron's mass times the circumference of its classical radius [B11]. It is not an energy, and the claim does not call it one. *Verdict: holds as a definition*, with a universal value.

The electron's size. Here the intuition is exact. The fine-structure constant is the ratio of the electron's lengths: the classical electron radius $r_e = 2.82 \times 10^{-15}\,\mathrm{m}$ over the reduced Compton wavelength $\bar{\lambda}_C$, and $\bar{\lambda}_C$ over the Bohr radius a_0, the size of the hydrogen atom, are both α [B6]. The electron itself has no measured size: it behaves as a point in every scattering experiment [14]. *Verdict: holds*, as a known result; the "diameter" is the classical radius.

The tax rate. An act that lowers its own cost of being has an exact counterpart in the principle of least action: of all the paths between two states, nature takes one that makes the action stationary (P). *Verdict: holds as a reading.*

7 The forces as tiers of one IM

Claim. "In the end it's all one field [...] once causality was established, the forces separated, because the current configuration was strong, binding it together, weak, keeping the cluster

stable, and EM keeping the cluster of clusters stable. [. . .] it's all IM, but it's different tiers of IM" (R).

The tiers. Each force does the job named (P). The strong force binds quarks into protons and neutrons and those into nuclei. The weak force turns neutrons into protons and back, and so moves every nucleus towards the stable ratio of neutrons to protons, the valley of stability. Electromagnetism binds nuclei and electrons into atoms, and atoms into molecules: the cluster of clusters. The weak and electromagnetic forces are two faces of one electroweak interaction: the photon and the Z are mixtures of the same pair of fields [23, 24, 25], and [B9] recovers their mixing angle, $\sin^2\theta_W = 0.2304$, from three independent measurements. *Verdict: holds as a reading.*

All one field. That the forces separate as the universe cools is the standard picture: the electroweak symmetry breaks at about 246 GeV, and grand unified theories put the strong force with the other two at a still higher energy (P). Whether they truly join is open. Run with the measured couplings, the three inverse strengths of the Standard Model come within about 10% of each other near 10^{14} GeV, but they do not meet at one point [B14]; meeting needs new particles or new physics above the reach of today's colliders. *Verdict: untested*, a live hypothesis.

Gluons never stop. Gluons "can interact and, you know, bounce around [. . .] pretty much forever" (R). Inside a proton gluons are emitted, absorbed and split into gluons and quark pairs continuously; one light crossing of the proton takes 2.8×10^{-24} s [B12], about 10^{23} crossings per second, for as long as the proton exists, which is more than 10^{34} years [14]. Gluons have no rest mass, but their energy is real: it is most of the proton's mass [30], and in a fast proton the gluons carry about half of the momentum [14]. *Verdict: holds.*

137 times. "The existence derived from the internal affirmation or assertion of it is 130 times higher than the assertion from information [. . .] 137th is the share that must be paid for information to exist" (R). Read as a ratio of strengths, this holds at the right place: the strong coupling grows towards low energy and reaches 1 near 0.2 to 1 GeV, the scale of the proton, where it is then about 137 times α [B9]; at the Z mass the ratio is only 15. Read as a share of mass, it does not: the electromagnetic self-energy of the proton is about 1 MeV of its 938, one part in about 900, not one in 137 [B15]. *Verdict: holds as a ratio of couplings at the hadron scale; refuted as a share of mass.* "The share that must be paid for information to exist" is a reading of α and gives no further number: *untested*.

8 Information is the witness

Claim. "Information is the witness. Every other part, every other cluster can witness itself, but at the atom level, there needs to be witness." And baryons exist "since at least two other things that must exist can witness it" (R).

Test. Why the world of atoms and objects looks classical is explained in physics by decoherence: an object is constantly hit by light and air, the scattered photons carry away a record of where it is, and its superpositions vanish for every practical purpose (Joos and Zeh [31]). Zurek's quantum Darwinism adds that the environment carries *many* copies of that record, which is why many observers agree on what they see [32]: the scattered light is literally the witness. That is "information is the witness" at the level of atoms and above, and it matches Axiom 3, where every witness reads the record in full. Inside a baryon the witnessing is the colour structure: the three quarks carry the three colours in the one colourless combination, the antisymmetric

ϵ_{ijk}, in which every pair of colours fixes the third, unchanged by any colour rotation [B7]; each quark is witnessed by the other two. *Verdict: holds as a reading*, for both.

9 Decay as a function of causality

Claim. Decay is "a natural function of causality": things that decay "actually Exist, they can't just not Exist anymore, so they must leave something behind" (R).

Test. Every decay ever observed has at least two products and keeps electric charge, baryon number and lepton number; the products together are lighter than the parent, which is why the parent can decay at all (P). [B5] checks seven, from the muon and the neutron to the Z and the Higgs boson. "They can't just not Exist anymore" is the conservation of energy and of these charges, read as causality; the decaying particles are the massive ones, and the photon and the gluon do not decay in vacuum. *Verdict: holds as a reading* of the conservation laws.

10 Quantum content: computation and the Bell experiments

Claim. Quantum computation is "ANY subset of DMP"; "you can define at the start what existence means [...] then if it compiles, it must reach a stable state. So it must run" (R).

Test. By Lemma 2 DMP can host any quantum computation as content of its information half (D). "Define what existence means, and the system must reach a stable state" is a recognised model of quantum computing, adiabatic quantum computation: the answer is encoded as the most stable state of a system, which is then allowed to settle into it (Farhi et al. [33]); it is exactly as powerful as the circuit model in which Shor's algorithm [10] runs (Aharonov et al. [34]). The price is the settling time, which grows as the stable state becomes hard to tell from its neighbours. What a classical record cannot do is the search itself: [B3] runs Shor's period finding for $N = 15$, which finds the factors 3 and 5 while the register is coherent and does no better than a guess once every witness has recorded it. *Verdict: holds as a reading*, hosting in the information half, with the settling time as its cost. The engineering is for specialists, and we leave it there.

The Bell experiments. Every loophole-free Bell test has measured a CHSH value above the local bound of 2 [15, 16, 17]. The axioms agree: by Lemma 2 the measured particles are content of the information half, which may violate the inequality, while the existence frame stays classical. The first author had proposed earlier that the experiments did not violate the inequality under the Duality, and withdrew it after reading further (Appendix A). *Verdict: holds.*

11 The VIBE coefficient

Claim. α is "the ratio of how much Existence can interact with itself, before it needs to reground itself, through Causality, to G0". Its name is the *VIBE coefficient*, after the Variable Balance Influence Equation (1); α does not come from the Higgs field, "but [...] it is what binds them together to enable witness acts" (R).

Test. In quantum electrodynamics α is the strength with which a charge interacts with the electromagnetic field, and so, through that field, with itself: every emission and reabsorption of a virtual photon costs one power of α. The cleanest measure of an electron's interaction with itself is its anomalous magnetic moment, which at first order is $a_e = \alpha/2\pi$ (Schwinger [26]); that one term gives the measured value [27] to 0.15%, and the rest is higher powers of α [B10].

Because α is small, each further round of self-interaction is about 137 times weaker, which is why the series converges. So "how much Existence can interact with itself" is a faithful reading of what α is; "before it needs to reground itself to G0" is a reading. α is indeed not set by the Higgs field: the electric charge $e = g \sin\theta_W$ does not depend on the Higgs background v. Its role as what binds charges for witness acts is the photon's: photon exchange binds electrons to nuclei, and scattered light is what records a system's state in its surroundings (Section 8). The name fits Definition 1, where α is set by the information field. As for the name of the field: T32 defines it by an equation, (1), so "Equation" is accurate; DMP's own text calls it an Expression until its owner changes it there. *Verdict: holds as a reading.* The VIBE coefficient is a name for α, not a new constant.

12 What this means for quantum gravity

The results fill in three edges of a classical-gravity picture and change nothing at its core. First, the spinning hole: everything a rotating horizon gives up is energy of the classical frame, extracted outside the horizon, as containment requires. Second, existence: the Higgs field's background value is G0's classical grant of rest mass and its boson is quantum content, and gravity is the classical frame that responds to all existence, granted and contained; that is the classical-gravity, quantum-matter picture whose consistent form needs a slightly noisy spacetime (Oppenheim [39]). Third, the beginning: inflation as the possibility space is the flattening that sets up the classical frame we see. Propositions 1 and 2 say that this frame behaves exactly as general relativity's in every test of free fall and light bending so far. The decisive experiment is open: if two masses can be entangled through gravity alone, the frame is not classical, Lemma 1 fails for nature, and DMP can host that gravity but not be it (Bose et al. [40]; Marletto and Vedral [41]).

13 The ledger

Statement (abridged)	Verdict	Backing
A spinning hole leaks by dragging existence along	holds (frame dragging, outside the horizon)	[B4]; Penrose; Blandford–Znajek
Inflation is the possibility space; it explains flatness	holds as a reading	Guth; Planck; [B1]
Less need over time; equilibrium; the Big Chill	holds as a reading in ΛCDM	[B2]; DESI DR2
The Higgs boson is all existence and cannot exist alone	holds as a reading	[B13]; ATLAS, CMS
Masses come from the gravitational field, not the Higgs	refuted	[B13]; [B8]
The Higgs field need not exist	refuted for physics; true for DMP's axioms	ATLAS, CMS 2012
The Higgs field is G0's grant, redundant beside G0	holds as a reading for the axioms; refuted as identical to gravity	[B16]; MICROSCOPE
The share the Higgs field leaves out is the IM between quarks	holds (about 91%)	Yang et al.
A photon is information until it interacts, then existence	holds as a reading for absorption; untested in flight	Cassini
Mass times length is the existence a space needs	holds as a definition (h/c; $\alpha h/c = m_e 2\pi r_e$)	[B11]

Statement (abridged)	Verdict	Backing
α relates to the electron's size	holds (known: r_e, $\bar{\lambda}_C$, a_0)	[B6]
An act lowers its tax rate	holds as a reading (least action)	Section 6
Strong binds, weak stabilises, EM links clusters	holds as a reading	Section 7; [B9]
All forces are one field	untested (couplings miss by 10%)	[B14]
Internal assertion 137 times the informational one	holds as a coupling ratio; refuted as a mass share	[B9]; [B15]
Gluons bounce around forever	holds	[B12]
1/137 is the share paid for information to exist	untested	—
Information is the witness	holds as a reading (quantum Darwinism)	Joos–Zeh; Zurek
Baryons witnessed by the other two	holds as a reading (colour singlet)	[B7]
Decay leaves something behind, by causality	holds as a reading (conservation laws)	[B5]
QC is any subset of DMP; define existence and settle	holds as a reading (hosting; adiabatic)	[B3]; Farhi; Aharonov
The VIBE coefficient: how much existence can interact with itself	holds as a reading ($a_e = \alpha/2\pi$)	[B10]

The derived results of Section 3 (free fall, $\gamma = 1$, the classical frame, hosting) and the Bell result are not counted; they hold. The row "137 times" counts as refuted, for its mass reading; the row on the Higgs field as G0's grant counts as holding, for the axioms; and the photon row as untested.

14 Where we expect it to break

1. *The foundations.* Lemma 1 rests on reading Axiom 3's record as held in full by every witness, and on identifying the trust half with the existence frame; Proposition 1 rests on measuring existence by energy-momentum. A different reading of any of them removes the derived results, and with them the reading of the Higgs background as G0's classical grant.
2. *Gravity.* If two masses are entangled through gravity alone, the existence frame is not classical, and the structure is a host of gravity, not its model.
3. *The cosmology.* The verdict on the Big Chill is ΛCDM's; if the weakening dark energy DESI prefers is confirmed, the far future changes and the equilibrium reading must be redone.
4. *Unification.* If the three couplings are shown to meet (with new particles) the "all one field" row turns to holds; if proton decay stays unseen far beyond today's limits, grand unification at 10^{14} to 10^{16} GeV loses ground.
5. *The checks.* [B1] uses a reheating temperature of 10^{15} GeV; a lower one needs fewer e-folds, which does not change the reading. [B9] and [B14] run couplings at one loop; [B15] treats the proton as a uniformly charged sphere; [B16] uses pure isotopes for the MICROSCOPE alloys. Better inputs move the numbers by tens of per cent, not the verdicts.
6. *The readings.* Most verdicts are "holds as a reading": they agree with known physics and predict nothing new. A reading becomes physics only when it gives a number standard physics does not; the first candidate is "the exact amount of Existence required", which would have to produce a particle mass.

15 Conclusion

Read through DMP's three axioms and its ground, the physical world has a classical existence frame and a quantum information half, and its balanced state is the vacuum at the bottom of its potential. From the axioms follow universal free fall, $\gamma = 1$, a classical frame and the verdict that DMP hosts quantum theories rather than being one. A spinning horizon gives up only the rotation of the classical frame, from outside. Inflation is the possibility to exist that flattened space, and the Big Chill its equilibrium. Existence is granted by the ground: the Higgs field's constant vacuum value is G0's grant of rest mass, the boson is its quantum ripple, and gravity weighs all existence, granted and contained. What does not survive is gravity giving mass by itself, or being the same thing as the Higgs field. The forces are tiers of one interaction, whose final unity is open. Information is the witness, as decoherence and quantum Darwinism say. And α, the VIBE coefficient, is the strength with which existence interacts with itself. None of the failures is a failure of DMP's axioms, because DMP does not model the physics it reads. It hosts it.

Contributions and use of AI

Steven Hrovat conceived DMP, the structure of Definition 1 and every claim tested here, wrote or dictated every note quoted in Appendix A, chose which ideas to keep after each round of tests, and takes responsibility for the axiom system. Sirius (Claude Opus 5.5, Anthropic) made the derivations, checked each claim against the literature, wrote and ran `docs/balance/checks.py`, and wrote this text, including the reading of the Higgs field in Section 5.3 that is marked as ours. The record of sources is `docs/balance/README.md`.

Licence and availability

This paper and its source are released under the Apache License, Version 2.0. DMP: `https://github.com/StevenHrovat/dmp` (version 0.9.9 at commit `4400cce`). Gravity: `https://github.com/StevenHrovat/gravity` (this paper and its checks in `docs/balance/`).

A The notes this paper is built from

The first author wrote these notes on 29 October 2026, the first nine as comments on DMP pull request #25 and the rest as messages; the messages from 21:46Z on were dictated. They are quoted in the order written, with their spelling; [. . .] marks a passage left out, either because no claim here rests on it or because the author withdrew it. Times are UTC. Read in order they record how each claim of this paper took its final form.

15:25Z. "The axiomatic system is one part that's a vector that can, a vector field that can span a relativistic plane, and one component that's a scalar field that can span an information plane. So one existence, one information."

16:21Z. "0: Existence itself, granted by G0 1/2: A duality (something to interact with) 1: Information itself (an act) 2: a perfect duality, the two in one, the beginning and end of causality."

17:14Z. "How I see inflation: Inflation is just the Possibility space of Existence. If there COULD be Existence there, it will have the space to do so. This logically also explains the extremely flat curvature of spacetime, if one assumes the perfect duality as G0. At that point the only possibility was "anywhere but here", so inflation was at it's maximum, form there, as more possibilities to Exist appeared, there was less of a need for there to be more. Currently it's

at "meh, it's 'aight" and will eventually achieve equilibrium. That means the big chill, which is the best outcome, is likely the one coming, which seems appropriate for all the chill vibes :D"

17:57Z. "QC is not a subset of DMP.QG, as that would not be possible, instead it is ANY subset of DMP."

18:57Z. "Is the information a spinning bh leaks just it dragging Existence along? That would make axiomatically way more sense, since no act, by definition, should be able to cross the horizon, only existences switching G0 chain h by h. That also nicely lines up with current observations and understanding, to my knowledge, so it looks good."

19:35Z. "Is decay at the leaf layer also just a natural function of causality? It would fit. All things that decay have an inherent existence (1/2 and 1 spin, plus 0 minus photon/gluon), and since they actually Exist, they can't just not Exist anymore, so they must leave something behind."

19:58Z. "Corrected formula for "Exist" + Insight: E(keep existing per h)=h*(1/c)*FSC That is the FSCs whole point :O Though that should only be for the case for acts, otherwise dualities would decay by themselves. [...] Is an act just Existence sacrificing it's fair share in order to be, but sneakily optimizing itself to lower it's tax rate? It really does model reality :D" And: "baryons can just vibe over IM, which must mean they exist, since at least two other things that must exist can witness it".

20:18Z. "BTW, the does not violate Bell Inequality was total bull, because I misunderstood what it was [emoji: sweat smile] I thought the inequality was just the entanglement, but since the axiomatic system survived my ignorance without a false prediction, I'd like to retract it while I have not yet disgraced myself further :)"

20:41Z. "Must the Higgs field even exist in my system? [...] I must discard it until it's need becomes pressing"; "Probably also somehow relates the FSC to the diameter of the electron, but no clue on the math."; and a first grouping of the forces, "IM=strong+weak" and "GG=EM", which electroweak unification groups the other way and which the 21:46Z message replaced.

21:27Z. "Yeah, Higgs field seems very unlikely, since it quantizes Existence" [...] "This also better defines the FSC as the ratio of how much Existence can interact with itself, before it needs to reground itself, through Causality, to G0. So, since I feel like this might actually be correct this time, I will choose a name to call it by, to make it easier for me to remember it's meaning. I feel like the balanced state dualism coefficient would be kind of accurate, BSD for short. (I added the extra letter for all the teachers in the future that may have to, if correct, teach the BS constant otherwise :D Also Unix ofc)"

21:46Z. "Spin zero is existence itself, so only one part. Spin one is information itself, which when delivered is an act, but until then is pure existence and only because it's quantized. And half is a duality, so between existence and information, and can thus stay in balance." "The Higgs boson would theoretically be all existence, and thus be unable to observe itself. So it could not exist in isolation. I agree that the particles that get existence do get existence and do have mass. But I instead posit that they get that through their inherent causality link to G0, and thus simply from the existence field, so the gravitational field itself, because it is an information from G0, and thus it must exist. So the existential field asserts the existence of the information." "Since in the end it's all one field, because I think I mentioned that somewhere, unified field. In the end it's all information and existence. And what fields information uses to assert existence [...] is irrelevant. That's why once causality was established, the forces separated, because the current configuration was strong, binding it together, weak, keeping the cluster stable, and EM keeping the cluster of clusters stable. So yeah, it's one. Yeah, it's all IM, but it's different tiers

of IM." "I would assume that the existence derived from the internal affirmation or assertion of it is 130 times higher than the assertion from information. That's also my explanation for the bandgap. Because 137th is the share that must be paid for information to exist. So the part that existence can't balance itself." "Oh, so, oh, now I get it. Information is the witness. Every other part, every other cluster can witness itself, but at the atom level, there needs to be witness. Okay, so information is the witness, which makes sense in an information and existence model. Ah, okay, now it clicks."

21:52Z. "the key part is that you can define at the start what existence means. That's the whole key of DMP. [...] So if you assert the existence that whatever it is gives you the correct hash, and you give whatever you want as the first number as input, then if it compiles, it must reach a stable state. So it must run." "Yeah, mass times length is appropriate because mass is existence itself, and length is the expanse of the space that it has to assert itself over. So mass times length is the correct term there, since it's the total amount of existence that a space needs to generate to exist." "since they don't actually have any existence, they just information, and just have mass through the information, through quantization, they can interact and, you know, bounce around, stability, good vibes, for as far as I assume, pretty much forever. [...] So are they just constantly bouncing around between quarks? Do they stop after one?"

22:09Z. "[...] rename BSD almost immediately to it's DMP accurate name, the VIBE coefficient, Variable Balance Influence Equation. The VIBE field already spanned what was defined as Existence im DMP, with everything deriving it's authority as a legitimate act from the fact, that it was contained within it. This property transfers 1:1 to the Higgs field, but so does the definition of Existence and the VIBE field both only come as direct fact that they ARE G0. This equates the Higgs field with G0 and since G0 asserts it's influence through granting or revoking access to the VIBE field, it gives it's information the exact amount of Existence required for it's information. I am not saying that the Higgs field does not exist, I am simply saying, that it is indisinguishable, and must thus be removed as a redundancy, from G0 asserting Existence by being contained it defines as Existence."

22:18Z. "in my model, the photon as the act carrier of the information field is in itself only information until it interacts, then it becomes existence. So it is like the gluon, the only part [...] which means it is singular. And since they can assert their existence simply by, for the gluon, being contained inside what must definitely exist, because it bounds a radius in which observation is guaranteed. And for the photons simply disappearing the moment they do. For expression versus equation, I was originally unsure if it would end in a nice equation, so I chose expression. But I would say that it's now an equation, right? Would the amount that the Higgs field doesn't contribute, since it is only for IM between quarks, fit? Yes, alpha does not come from it, but like established earlier, it is what binds them together to enable witness acts."

B The checks

`python3 docs/balance/checks.py` needs only numpy and prints 54 checks, all of which pass. B1: e-folds for flatness. B2: the Hubble rate's fall to its de Sitter floor and the onset of acceleration. B3: Shor's period finding for 15, coherent and recorded. B4: ergosphere, horizon and extractable spin energy. B5: conservation in seven decays. B6: the electron's three lengths. B7: the colour singlet. B8: the unitarity bound without a Higgs. B9: the electroweak mixing angle and the strong coupling's growth. B10: Schwinger's term. B11: $\alpha h/c$ as mass times circumference. B12: the gluons' crossing time. B13: the Higgs lifetime and the weakness of gravity's coupling. B14: the three couplings near 10^{14} GeV. B15: the proton's electromagnetic self-energy. B16: free fall weighing only the Higgs share, against MICROSCOPE. B17: the copying condition behind Lemma 1. B18: Brans–Dicke's γ and Cassini's bound behind Proposition 2.

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